LESSON 3

Mary had a little lamb

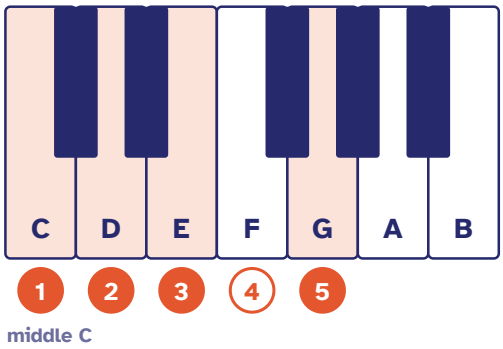
A rhyme by Sarah Josepha Hale, first printed in Boston in 1830, about a lamb that followed a girl to school. We sing it to the tune of *Merrily we roll along*.

IN THIS SONG **4/4** **four notes: C D E G** **the C position** **steps and a skip**

LISTEN FIRST
Scan the code: listen to the whole song once, then hum along the second time.

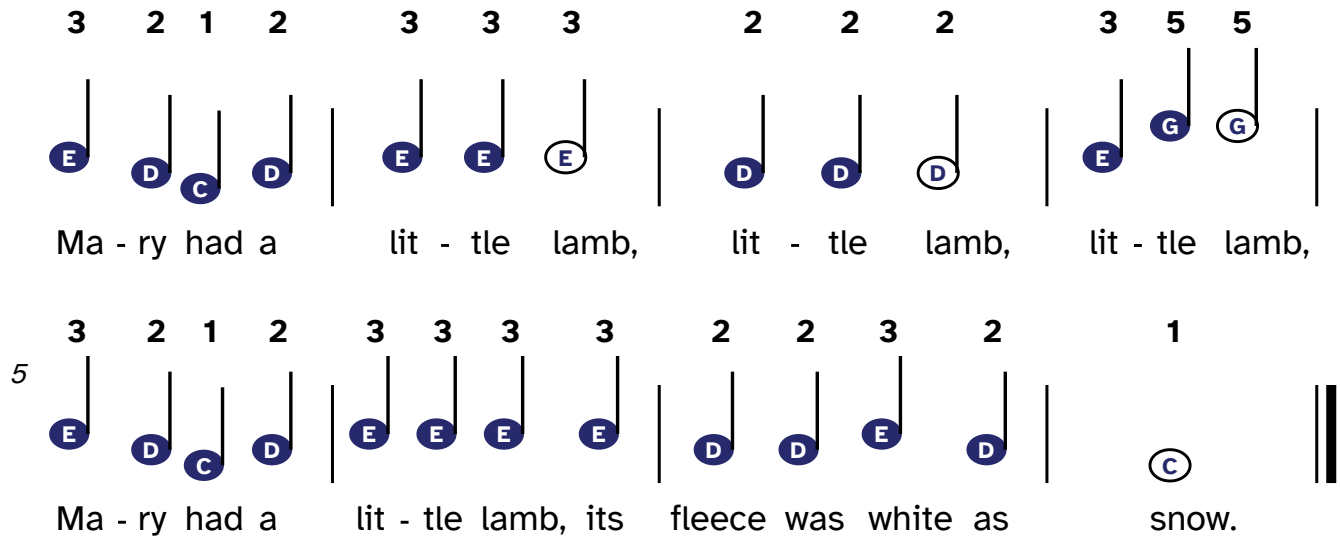
1 Meet the song

Listen, pointing to each note as it sounds. Then sing it with the words.



Your hand: C position. Right thumb on middle C, a finger on each key up to G. The song's notes are lit.

Steps and a skip. Most notes move by a step, to the next key. Only once does the tune skip a key: E up to G.



THE WOW MOMENT

☆ **Spooky Mary.** Move your whole hand so the thumb sits on A, two keys down from C, and play the song with the same fingers. Same song, new house: it turns dark and minor. Your first spooky music.

☐ **Listened and pointed** ☐ **Sang it with the words**

2 Take it apart

The same song, one piece at a time: first its rhythm, then its notes.

THE RHYTHM

Say the words in time, then clap and count: clap on the coral numbers, hold through the grey ones.

THE TIME

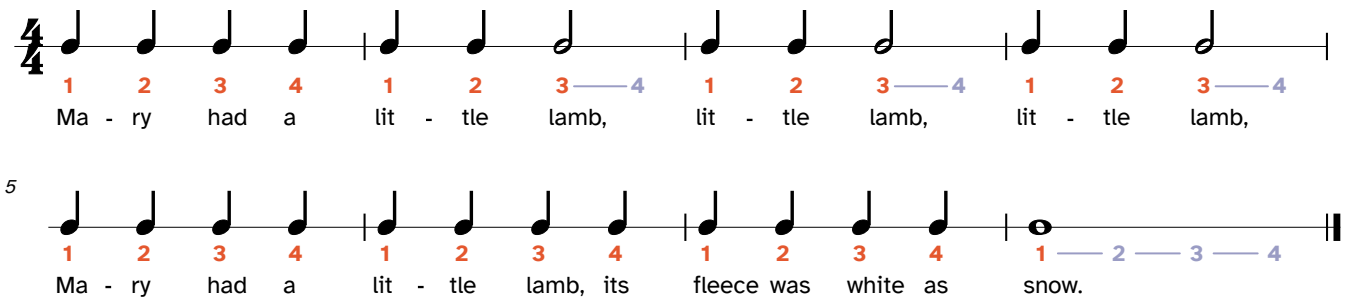
4/4

Top 4: four beats in every bar.
Bottom 4: a crotchet is one beat.

THE NOTES

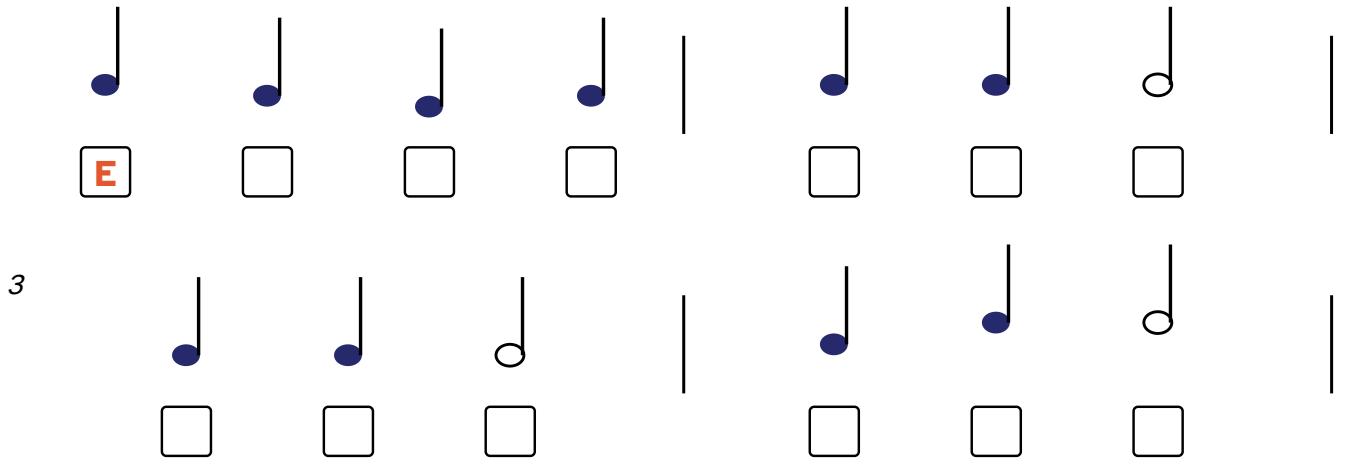


crotchet — 1 beat ●
minim — 2 beats ●●
semibreve — 4 beats ●●●●



THE NOTES

Write the letter name of every note in the first four bars; the first one is done. Then find the skip: in which bar does the tune jump from E up to G? ☐

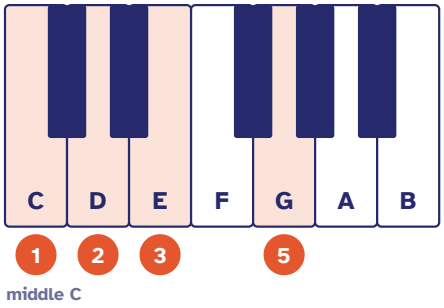


SPOT THE MISTAKE Your teacher plays the song with one wrong note. Put up your hand when you hear it, then find it on the page.

☐ **Said it in time** ☐ **Clapped it** ☐ **Wrote the letters** ☐ **Spotted the mistake**

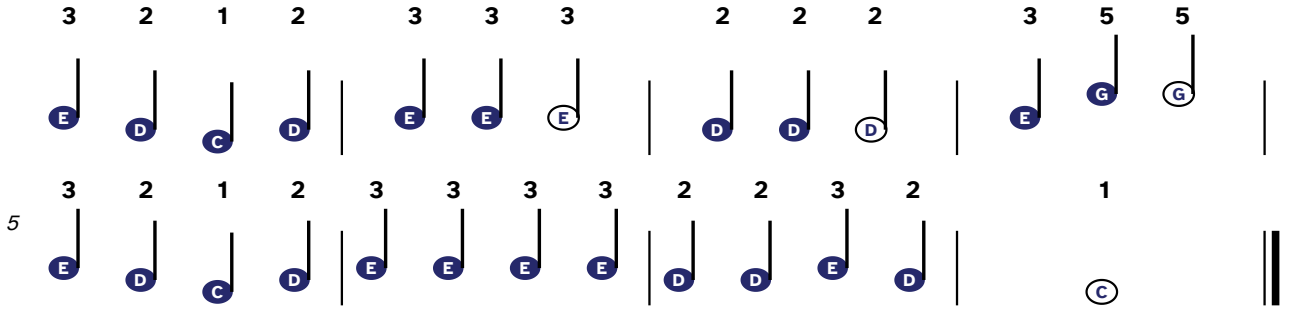
3 Play it

Four white keys now, C D E and G: the right hand, then the left.

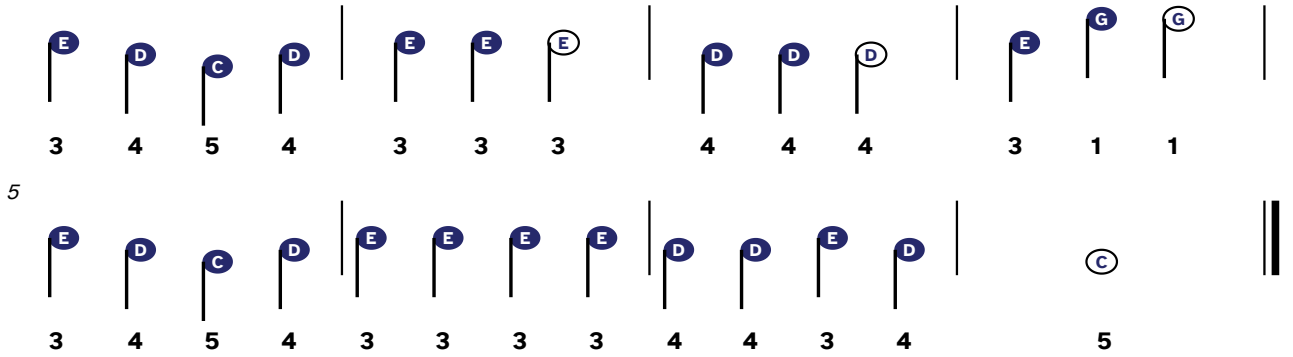


Right hand: the C position, thumb on middle C: 1 on C, 2 on D, 3 on E, 5 on G. **Left hand:** an octave lower, 5 on C, 4 on D, 3 on E, thumb on G.

R RIGHT HAND the C position



L LEFT HAND an octave lower



4 · CHECK

☐ I can say and clap it ☐ I can sing it with the words ☐ I can find the skip, E up to

I can play it: colour a step each time you climb

	With letters	No letters	With the band	Fast
Right hand				
Left hand				

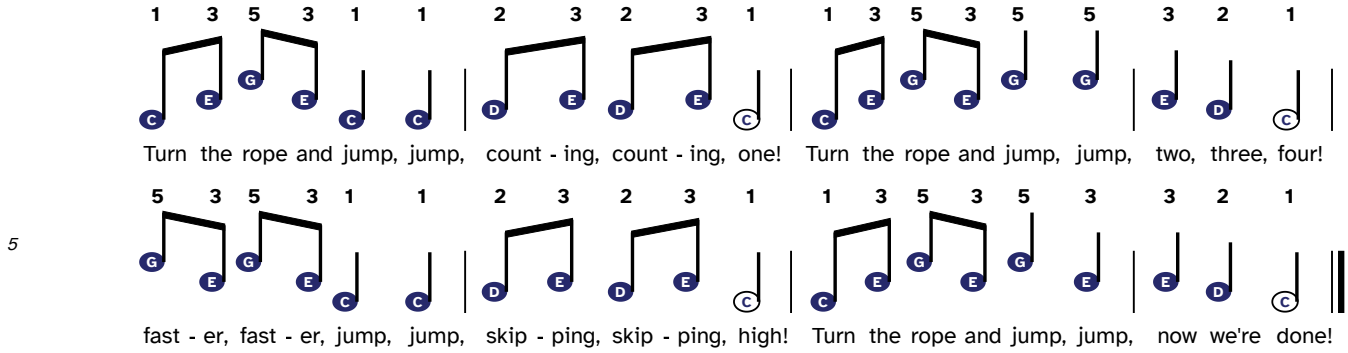
TEACHER ☐ Pass ☐ Not yet

+ More to play

Use what this lesson taught in new ways, then take a first look at the next lesson.

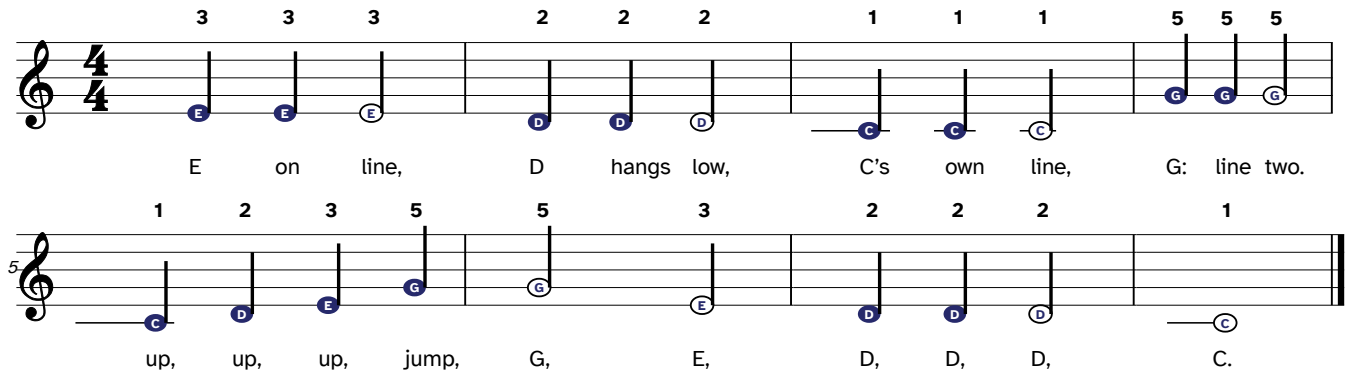
JUMP ROPE

Bouncy and quick: the four keys with skips, C E G, like a rope going round. Keep the running notes light.



HELLO, STAFF

Calm and careful, a peek at Lesson 4: the same notes on five lines. E sits on the bottom line, D hangs below it, C has a little line of its own, G sits on line two.



MAKE IT YOURS

Pick one and play the whole song that way. Can your teacher guess which?

- [ ] **Spooky: thumb on A, the same fingers**
- [ ] **Skipping: light and bouncy, like Mary's lamb**
- [ ] **Up high: an octave higher**

5 MINUTES AT HOME

1. Listen to the song once
2. Right hand, twice
3. Left hand, twice
4. Spooky Mary, thumb on A

☐ ☐ ☐ ☐ ☐ ☐ ☐
M T W T F S S